

PRESENTATION WALKTHROUGH

Energy AI Hackathon 2026

Oil Production Prediction Using Machine Learning

Team Brain Oil

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This walkthrough is designed to help you present our project confidently. Each section corresponds to slides in the PowerPoint and cells in the Jupyter notebook. Use it as your speaking notes during the presentation.

Symbol	Meaning
SAY:	What to say out loud to the audience
SHOW:	What to point to or demonstrate
KEY POINT:	The main takeaway for that section
TRANSITION:	How to smoothly move to the next topic

PRESENTATION TIMELINE (10 minutes)

Section	Time	Slides
Introduction & Problem	1 min	1-2
Data & Methodology	3 min	3-6
Results & Why Ridge Won	3 min	7-10
Predictions & Uncertainty	2 min	11-12
Conclusion & Q&A	1 min	13-14

PART 1: INTRODUCTION

Slides 1-2 | Notebook Cells 1-3

Opening (Slide 1)

SAY: "Good morning! We are Team Brain Oil, and today we'll show you how we predict oil production for 12 new wells using machine learning."

SHOW: Point to team names on the title slide.

The Challenge (Slide 2)

SAY: "The challenge is simple but important: Given well log data from 71 existing wells where we know how much oil they produced, can we predict what 12 new wells will produce over 3 years?"

- We have 71 training wells with known production
- We need to predict for 12 test wells (IDs 72-83)
- Output: Point estimate + 100 uncertainty scenarios per well

KEY POINT: This is like predicting house prices from features - but for oil wells.

TRANSITION: "Let me show you the data we worked with..."

PART 2: DATA & METHODOLOGY

Slides 3-6 | Notebook Cells 4-15

Understanding the Data (Slide 3)

SAY: "Each well has multiple measurements at different depths - about 21 readings per well. These include porosity, permeability, and other rock properties."

- **Porosity (phi)** - How much empty space in the rock (storage capacity)
- **Permeability (perm)** - How easily oil can flow through the rock
- **Gamma Ray (GR)** - Helps identify rock types (sand vs. shale)

Handling Missing Data (Slide 4)

SAY: "Real-world data has gaps. Instead of throwing away incomplete records, we used a smart technique called MICE - it fills in missing values by learning patterns from the data."

"MICE + CART is the gold standard for missing data, recommended by Van Buuren in his 2018 textbook."

Aggregation: Multi-Row to Single-Row (Slide 5)

SAY: "Here's the key insight - each well has ~21 depth readings, but we need ONE prediction per well. So we aggregate: calculate the mean, standard deviation, minimum, and maximum of each property."

SHOW: Diagram showing 21 rows becoming 1 row with summary statistics.

Feature Engineering (Slide 6)

SAY: "We created 19 industry-standard features that petroleum engineers actually use:"

- **RQI & FZI** - Rock quality indicators from Amaefule (1993)
- **Net-to-Gross** - Proportion of productive rock
- **Best Zone Features** - Properties at the highest-quality depth
- **Spatial Features** - Location and sand proportion from geology maps

KEY POINT: We started with 105 features and narrowed down to 10 optimal ones.

TRANSITION: "Now, which model did we choose and why?"

PART 3: RESULTS & WHY RIDGE WON

Slides 7-10 | Notebook Cells 16-25

Model Comparison (Slide 7)

SAY: "We tested 57 different configurations across 4 model types. Here's what we found:"

Model	Test R ²	Verdict
Ridge Regression	0.9905	WINNER
Random Forest	0.85	Good
XGBoost	0.82	Acceptable
Elastic Net	0.88	Good

Why Ridge Beat Complex Models (Slide 8)

SAY: "You might ask - why did a simple model beat fancy ones like XGBoost? The answer is in the data size."

"For small datasets ($n < 100$), regularized linear models often outperform tree-based ensembles due to lower variance." — Hastie, Tibshirani & Friedman (2009), The Elements of Statistical Learning

SAY: "With only 71 training wells, complex models overfit. Ridge keeps it simple and stable."

Our Performance Metrics (Slide 9)

Metric	Our Result	Industry Benchmark	Status
Test R ²	0.9905	≥ 0.93 = Excellent	EXCELLENT
CV R ²	0.9539 ± 0.05	Stable	VERY STABLE
RMSE	1.57M BBL	< 10% of mean	4.7% - GREAT

SAY: "R² of 0.99 means our model explains 99% of the variation in oil production. The error is only 4.7% of the average production - well within industry standards."

Feature Importance (Slide 10)

SAY: "The top predictor is porosity - phi_mean. This makes perfect sense because porosity directly measures how much oil the rock can store."

- More pore space = more oil storage = higher production
- This aligns with fundamental reservoir engineering principles

KEY POINT: Simple model + domain knowledge = best results.

TRANSITION: "Let me show you our actual predictions..."

PART 4: PREDICTIONS & UNCERTAINTY

Slides 11-12 | Notebook Cells 26-32

Final Predictions (Slide 11)

SAY: "Here are our predictions for the 12 new wells. Production ranges from about 15 million to 47 million barrels over 3 years."

SHOW: Point to the prediction chart showing all 12 wells.

Uncertainty Quantification (Slide 12)

SAY: "Predictions are only useful if we know how confident we are. We used a technique called Bagging - training 100 different models and combining their predictions."

- Each model sees a slightly different sample of the data
- This gives us 100 different predictions (R1-R100)
- The spread shows our uncertainty for each well

"Bagging reduces variance by averaging over bootstrap samples." — Breiman (1996)

KEY POINT: We don't just give a number - we give a range of possibilities.

TRANSITION: "Let me wrap up with our key takeaways..."

PART 5: CONCLUSION

Slides 13-14 | Summary

Key Achievements (Slide 13)

SAY: "To summarize what we accomplished:"

1. **Excellent accuracy** - 99% R^2 , 4.7% error rate
2. **Research-backed approach** - Every decision supported by peer-reviewed literature
3. **Uncertainty quantification** - 100 scenarios per prediction for risk assessment
4. **Interactive application** - Streamlit app for real-time experimentation

Why Our Approach Works (Slide 13 continued)

SAY: "We succeeded because we matched the model complexity to the data size. With 71 wells, simplicity wins over complexity."

Thank You & Questions (Slide 14)

SAY: "Thank you for your attention. We're happy to answer any questions about our methodology, the domain science, or our interactive application."

ANTICIPATED Q&A;

Q: Why not use deep learning?

A: "Deep learning needs thousands of examples to work well. With only 71 wells, it would severely overfit. Our Ridge model is the right tool for this data size."

Q: How did you handle the spatial data?

A: "We used a smoothed 3x3 sand proportion map. The smoothing reduces noise while preserving the overall geological trends."

Q: What if the geology changes?

A: "Our uncertainty ranges capture this. Wells in less-characterized areas will show wider prediction intervals. The model learns from similar wells nearby."

Q: Can this scale to more wells?

A: "Absolutely. And with more data, we could explore more complex models. Our Streamlit app makes it easy to retrain with new data."

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Key Numbers to Remember

Item	Value
Training Wells	71
Test Wells	12 (IDs 72-83)
Test R^2	0.9905 (99%)
RMSE	1.57M BBL (4.7%)
Features Used	10 (from 105)
Uncertainty Scenarios	100 per well
Configurations Tested	57+

Academic References (If Asked)

- **Ridge Regression:** Hastie, Tibshirani & Friedman (2009)
- **Missing Data (MICE):** Van Buuren (2018)
- **Bagging:** Breiman (1996)
- **RQI/FZI:** Amaefule et al. (1993)

Winning Configuration

Setting	Value
Model	Ridge Regression
Alpha	0.1
Normalization	StandardScaler (CRITICAL)
Sand Map	Smooth 3x3
Feature Selection	Stepwise (105 → 10)

Uncertainty	Bagging Ensemble (100)
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Good luck with the presentation!

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